Daniel Steele

Software Engineer
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Profile

A driven software engineer with 8 years of industry experience in delivering enterprise solutions. I focus on delivering real business value, championing strong engineering practices wherever I go, and actively seek out new challenges to grow my impact.

Experience

AVP Applications Development Senior Programmer, Citi, Belfast — *Feb 2025 – Present*

- I work as part of a team of 3 maintaining a Citi implementation of Renovate a 3rd party dependency update manager, producing a forecasted cost-avoidance or $93 million this fiscal year.
- Refactored the API and service layer of the internal Renovate application at Citi, streamlining logic pathways and enforcing consistent coding standards to enable faster iteration and simpler, more consistent integration for other teams.
- Migrated the Renovate application from an in-memory solution handling approximately 10,000 repositories to a persistence-based solution now handling 30,000+ repositories and over 500000 dependencies.
- Refactored the service layer of the Renovate application allowing for faster iteration by reducing the number of logic pathways and ensuring a more consistent coding standard.
- Implemented a reporting tool widely adopted by senior leadership to support the organisational initiative of using Renovate to keep dependencies up to date and reduce vulnerability risk.
- I am currently leading a project to decouple the application to allow the UI to be split off into a React app served by a backend API.

Software Engineer II, Signifyd Ltd., Belfast — *Dec 2022 – Dec 2024*

- Automated the decision-making process, evidence generation, and submission for chargeback representment, leading to over 80% of representments having automated decisions, and approximately 15% having fully automated evidence generation and submission since its release.
- Optimised third-party API integrations to increase data collection, which improved representment decision-making and enabled more reliable automation.
- Onboarded and mentored an intern, supporting their rapid skill development and enabling them to contribute value quickly.
- Developed robust, extensively tested solutions using JUnit and Mockito for unit testing, complemented by a comprehensive suite of component and integration tests, as well as manual testing via Postman and the gRPC CLI.
- Contributed to the maintenance and support of a highly distributed microservices- based system hosted in AWS, applying architectural best practices to ensure seamless synchronization across modules utilising various AWS products e.g. SQS and EKS.
- Enhanced the public-facing API functionality, ensuring it remained up-to-date and well-documented with OpenAPI specifications.
- Designed and implemented solutions to maintain consistent data persistence across multiple data sources, including Elasticsearch, various RDS instances, and Cassandra.
- Utilized observability tools such as Datadog, Loggly, and Jaeger, in combination with Kubernetes, to monitor, diagnose, and resolve service incidents effectively.

Developer, High Speed Training, Leeds (Remote) — *Oct 2021 - Dec 2022*

- I enhanced the onboarding process for new learners, providing a more seamless user experience and reducing the need for manual intervention from customer support.
- I migrated legacy .aspx webpages to .NET Core with an Angular 11 front-end.

Application Developer, Fujitsu, Belfast — *Sept 2020 - Oct 2021*

- I updated the CSS and JS libraries for the DVLA website ensuring each page meets the new government accessibility and design standards.
- I integrated the new online license renewal system with the core legacy system for storing and updating vehicle and driver information.

Analyst Software Engineer, Neueda, Belfast — *Jul 2018 - Sep 2020*

- I completed a proof of concept (POC) project for CCEA, providing their development teams with the findings needed to move forward with full-scale application development.
- I led the development of a digital transformation project for DAERA, enabling effective tracking of departmental spending and audits, which reduced administrative overhead by approximately 70%.

Non-professional Experience

- I'm building a banking application in my own time, using Go on the backend and React on the frontend. By implementing every component myself, I'm deepening my understanding of banking architecture while picking up new technologies. The project has strengthened my system design skills, from breaking a domain into services to understanding how the parts fit together and reasoning about the trade-offs between them, and it has give me hands-on experience reverse engineering how real-world baking platforms work.

Education

- Queen's University Belfast - MSc Software Development, 2019
- Queen's University Belfast - BMus Music, 2017

Skills

Java	Scrum in Agile
Docker	HTML5
Kubernetes	SQL
Gradle	TDD
BootStrap	OOP
JavaScript	CSS3